

An illustration on the left side of the page depicts the Norse creation myth of Ask and Embla. A large, brown, stylized tree trunk with bare branches is shown in the center, appearing to be part of a landscape. In the foreground, three figures with long white hair and beards are shown from the chest up, looking towards the tree. They are wearing blue and red robes. The background features a yellow ground and a blue sky with white, wavy lines. A large, dark blue, jagged shape, resembling a mountain or a giant's head, is visible in the upper right corner.

Ask and Embla

Not long after Odin, together with his brothers Vili and Ve, formed the cosmos from the corpse of the giant Ymir, the gods decided to take a walk.

As they strode along a beach, boasting of their great deeds, Odin spied two objects washed up by the tide. Closer inspection revealed them to be tree trunks.

“Look here, brothers,” said Odin. “Tell me what you see.”

Vili shrugged. “Just some driftwood,” he replied. “Nothing special.”

“I agree,” Ve added. “Come on, I’m bored. Let’s have a wrestling match!”

But Odin continued to study the trees.

“Those smooth and shapely branches resemble limbs, and that thick foliage could be hair,” he said. “And do you see that cluster of knots and cracks in the bark? A nose, a mouth, eyes, eyebrows! Brothers, this driftwood looks just like us.”